

Belief in Angels



الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ فَاطِرِ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ جَاعِلِ الْمَلَائِكَةِ رُسُلًا أُولَى أَجْنَحَةٍ مِّثْنَى وَثَلَاثَ وَرُبْعَ ۚ
يَزِيدُ فِي الْخَلْقِ مَا يَشَاءُ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

Gratitude is for God only, Creator of the heavens and the earth, He who has made the angels as messengers, with two, three or four wings. He increases His creation according to His will. Indeed, God has power over all things. (35:1)

The beings through whom the Almighty sends down His directives for His creation are called angels. The Qur'ān uses the word (*al-malā'ikah*) for them, which is a plural of the word (*malak*), means "a messenger". In the above quoted verses, the Qur'ān itself has referred to the fact that the word *malā'ikah* has been chosen for them to connote this very meaning. Consequently, it is evident from the Qur'ān that it is through the angels that communication between this world and the one beyond it is established, and the Almighty is running the affairs of this world through them. The way this is done is that whatever directive they receive from the Almighty is implemented by them as His obedient subordinates. Their own intention or exercise of authority is not involved in this process in any way.

Responsibilities of the Angels

1. They implement the directives of God among His creation.
2. They reveal the messages of God to His prophets.
3. They write down and preserve the words and deeds of human beings
4. They descend with glad tidings and punishment for people
5. They remain busy in glorifying and exalting the Lord and pray to Him for the forgiveness of those who inhabit the earth
6. They claim the souls of people.
7. They are the companions of the faithful both in this world and in the Hereafter and give them glad tidings of Paradise at their death.
8. They shall be in charge of Hell

Belief in Divine Books

Belief in Divine Books

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا آمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَالْكِتَابِ الَّذِي نَزَّلَ عَلَى رَسُولِهِ وَالْكِتَابِ الَّذِي
أَنْزَلَ مِنْ قَبْلُ ۚ وَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِاللَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَكُتُبِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَلَالًا
بَعِيدًا

- *Believers! Have faith in God and His messenger, in the Book He has revealed to His messenger, and also in the books He has previously revealed and [remember that] he who denies God, His angels, His books and His prophets and the Last Day has strayed far. (4:136)*

- Just as the Almighty has sent prophets to guide mankind, similarly He has revealed His Books to these prophets for this purpose. The purpose of these Books is that people have with them the written guidance of God in His very words so that they can judge between what is right and what is wrong through these Books and are able to resolve their differences through them and in this manner they are able to adhere to the truth regarding their religion.

وَأَنْزَلَ مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ لِيَحْكُمَ بَيْنَ النَّاسِ فِي مَا اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ

- *And with these [Prophets], He sent down His Book as the decisive truth so that it may settle these differences between people. (2:213)*

وَأَنْزَلْنَا مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْمِيزَانَ لِيَقُومَ النَّاسُ بِالْقِسْطِ

- *And with these [Messengers] We sent down Our Book which is the Judge [between the right and the wrong] so that [through it] people are able to adhere to justice [regarding religion]. (57:25)*

The Torah

The Torah was revealed to Moses (sws). It is generally thought to be composed of five books which are found at the beginning of the Bible and which are called the Pentateuch. They are: **Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers and Deuteronomy.**

The Hebrew text of the Torah which is now found in manuscripts and published form is called the Massoretic Text.

The guidance of God provided by the prophets to mankind has two categories: the ***sharī'ah*** (*the law*) and the ***hikmah*** (*the wisdom*). It is the *sharī'ah* which constitutes the major portion of the Torah and thus it is named so on this basis.

The Psalms

The Psalms is the name of the book revealed to David (sws). It is a collection of hymns which are called Psalms. The Book of Psalms now found in the Bible has five books and one hundred and fifty Psalms. Although psalms attributed to other people have also found their way in this collection, but a discerning mind can feel the magnificence of a divine discourse in hymns about which it has been specified that they are from David (sws). Like the Gospel, it is the *hikmah* which constitutes the Psalms and the Qur'ān verifies it as a book revealed by God.

The Gospel

The Gospel was revealed to Jesus (sws). One of primary objectives of his advent was to give glad tidings of the last prophet. The word “Gospel” means “good news” and on this very basis it has been named so. As has been the case of divine scriptures, it too was revealed piecemeal keeping in view the needs of preaching and propagation. Before it could be compiled in the form of a Book, Jesus (sws) was lifted from this earth because of the rebellious and arrogant behaviour of his people. Thus it is not an arranged Book but independent orations and speeches which have reached later generations through the oral tradition and written memorandums.

- In the Bible, we find the four Gospels according to **Matthew, Mark, Luke** and **John**. They were originally written in Greek whereas the language of Jesus (sws) was Aramaic and he delivered his speeches and sermons in this language. The authors of these Gospels converted to Christianity much later than Jesus (sws) and none of these was written before 70 AD and the Gospel according to John was perhaps written a century after Jesus (sws)

The Qur'ān

This was revealed to Muhammad (sws), the last Prophet of God. It is regarded as the *mīzān* (scale that tells good from evil) and the *furqān* (distinguisher between good and evil) by the Almighty in the Qur'ān itself (42:17; 25:1) and a *muhaymin* on the previous scriptures. The word *muhaymin* which means “a guardian” and “a protector”. It means that the Qur'ān is the real authentic and trustworthy version of the Book of God. Thus, in matters of religion, everything accepted or rejected shall be decided under the guidance of the light provided by it.

It consists of 114 *sūrahs*, most of which form pairs with regard to their contents. They are composed in seven sections. Its language is Arabic and it has been revealed to the heart of the Prophet (sws) with the directive of God. The Prophet (sws) presented it to his people and from them it was transferred through the **consensus** and through the **verbal and written perpetuation** of the Muslims. Consequently, in divine literature, this is the only Book about which it can be said with full certainty that it is present with us in its original form, shape, language and arrangement without the slightest bit of change.

Various aspects of protection of the Qur'ān

First, during the time of revelation of the Qur'ān the Almighty made arrangements that the devils are unable to interfere in the process of divine revelation in any way.

Second, the angel which the Almighty selected to reveal the Qur'ān has been called by the Qur'ān (81:21) as “the one endued with power, held in honour before the Lord of the Throne, obeyed in Heaven, moreover trustworthy.”

Third, the very person who was entrusted with the Qur'ān was firstly, the best of human beings in all respects and secondly, the responsibility of memorizing, arranging and safeguarding the Qur'ān was taken up by the Almighty

Fourth, the Qur'ān is a miracle with regard to its eloquent selection of words and the meanings they convey. And so distinct is it in this aspect to other discourses that they cannot match it.

Fifth, together with the promise of protecting the Qur'ān, the Almighty has also promised to protect and safeguard its language till the Day of Judgement.